

2.3 Cropping Images

“To crop” literally means “to cut or trim.” As you’ve guessed, in Photoshop, cropping is nothing but retaining only a part of the image while leaving the rest out. Sometimes, your images may not have the subject in the main focus. Too much of the background can be a distraction to the viewer. There are other reasons, of course, for retaining only part of a picture.

2.3.1 Simple Cropping

All you need to do is select the portion you want to retain using the Marquee Tool, then go to the Image menu and choose Crop. You can also use the keyboard shortcut [Alt] + [I] to access the Image menu, and then press [P] to invoke the Crop command. If you are dissatisfied with the crop, or if you have cropped more than what is necessary, you can go back to the previous steps in the History palette.

2.3.2 Using the Crop Tool

Photoshop offers a more powerful option to crop images by way of the Crop Tool. Click on the Crop Tool to acti-

